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IGNIS WHITE PAPER



CONTROL PLAYBOOK

Procurement for Energy Developers

From package strategy to financial close, with agentic AI: remove the pauses between gates and keep contract, model and lender pack in step.

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Not legal, regulatory or investment advice. Facts checked 2 November 2026.

00 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Procurement loses its time between the gates. Find the pauses, then design them out.

For CEOs and procurement, commercial and finance leads at energy developers. One job: find and remove the pauses, rework and evidence failures between gates.

1 **What changed.** Three clocks run at once: an 18-month CfD spend milestone, 90 days to accept a grid offer and transformer lead times of up to 4 years.[1,2,3] EU auctions now test the ability to deliver.[6]

2 **The decision.** How far to take each package before award, who owns one date register, and which pauses to remove first.

3 **The evidence.** Each gate has entry and exit evidence. Offers are restated like for like, and contract, model and lender pack read one record.

4 **Agents and people.** Agents log, restate, cross-check and draft. Named people choose suppliers, allocate risk and sign.

5 **What you keep.** One project record per project: offers, clarifications, terms and lender answers, reused on the next package.

ANALYSIS

ONE MONTH OF WAITING, 60 MW SOLAR

about £0.22m

of contract value lost in today's money

TWO MONTHS

about £0.45m

if the start of contracted revenue slips by two months

Assumptions: 11% capacity factor, 7% discount rate, AR7 solar price of £65.23/MWh.[7] Working on page 6.

Tools you can use on Monday

- Pause audit worksheet
- Gate-control cards for seven gates
- Supplier-return structure
- Like-for-like comparison grid
- Clarification log and exception rules
- Seven measures to establish

Inside

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2 Seven gates, run in parallel 7
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4 Evidence and control at each gate 12
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7 Contract, model and lender pack 18
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Worked example; 10 Self-check 22

FACT sourced, numbered ANALYSIS Ignis calculation from facts IGNIS VIEW our opinion

ASSUMPTION replace with your own

Sources on this page: [1] DESNZ, AR8 CfD Agreement. [2] NESO. [3] IEA. [6] EU 2025/1176. [7] DESNZ, 10 Feb 2026. Full list at the end.

+ PROCUREMENT IN BRIEF

What procurement is, how it is changing, and where agentic AI fits

WHAT IT IS

For an energy developer, procurement is how the project buys what it will build. The team splits the project into packages (for example modules or turbines, electrical balance of plant, civil works and the grid connection), sounds the market, runs tenders, compares offers, negotiates contracts and then proves all of it to lenders at financial close. It sets the capex, the programme and the risk the project carries into construction.

How it is changing

STRATEGY

FACT Clocks now run in parallel: a UK CfD gives 18 months to show spend of at least 10% of pre-commissioning costs,[1] and a GB connection offer must be accepted within 90 days.[2]

BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT

FACT Procurement now feeds the bid: EU renewables auctions must test bidders' ability to deliver on time.[6] Supplier prices and slots shape what a developer can offer.

PROCUREMENT

FACT Large transformers can take up to 4 years and cables 2 to 3 years.[3] Rising costs have led developers to stop offshore projects in their current form.[4,5]

Where agentic AI changes the work

Agents carry the groundwork

- Assemble tender packs and return templates from one project record
- Log, de-duplicate and route every clarification
- Restate offers like for like, with gaps flagged
- Check contract, model and lender pack agree before each gate

People keep the decision

- Package strategy and pre-award spend
- Shortlist and preferred bidder
- Risk allocation, caps and security
- The signature

IGNIS VIEW The split between agent groundwork and human decision is the Ignis method, applied in this playbook to one workflow.

ABOUT THIS PLAYBOOK

Written for CEOs and procurement, commercial and finance leads at energy developers. Ignis advises on strategy, business development, procurement and agentic AI transformation, from development to financial close.

Sources on this page: [1] DESNZ, AR8 CfD Agreement. [2] NESO. [3] IEA. [4] Vattenfall. [5] Ørsted. [6] EU 2025/1176. Full list on page 25.



PART ONE | FIND THE PAUSES

Measure the waiting before you fix it

Where does a package wait between gates, what is it waiting for, and what does each month cost?

1	Where procurement really loses time	5
2	Seven gates, run in parallel	7
3	The pause audit and the measures to establish	9

Photo: Kristian Buus / 1010 Climate Action, CC BY 2.0 (creativecommons.org/licenses/by/2.0), via Wikimedia Commons.

01 WHERE PROCUREMENT REALLY LOSES TIME

Three clocks start at award, and none of them waits for a tender pack

Procurement teams rarely lose time inside a gate. They lose it between gates, while the next step waits for a decision, a document or an answer.

FACT

18 months

after a UK CfD is signed, the generator must show spend of at least 10% of pre-commissioning costs, or project commitments.[1]

FACT

90 days

to accept a GB transmission connection offer once it arrives.[2]

FACT

Up to 4 years

to secure large power transformers; cables take 2 to 3 years. Lead times have almost doubled since 2021.[3]

The UK award calendar for AR8

Date	What happens	Source
19 Nov 2026	AR8 budget notice and Notice of Auction	[8,10]
3 to 9 Dec 2026	Sealed bid window (indicative)	[8]
4 to 17 Mar 2027	Contracts signed and returned (indicative); the 18-month clock starts	[1,8]

When costs outrun the project

FACT In July 2023 Vattenfall stopped Norfolk Boreas in its current form, citing cost increases of up to 40%.[4] In May 2025 Ørsted stopped Hornsea 4 in its current form, citing higher supply chain costs, higher interest rates and increased risk.[5]

IGNIS VIEW Neither was a procurement failure. Both show how little room is left between award and investment decision.

Procurement now feeds the bid

FACT EU rules require renewables auctions to pre-qualify bidders on their ability to deliver on time, and to apply non-price criteria, including resilience, to at least 30% of the volume auctioned each year or 6 GW.[6]

IGNIS VIEW Supplier evidence now serves the round as well as the lenders. Gather it once.

Sources on this page: [1] DESNZ, AR8 CfD Agreement. [2] NESO. [3] IEA. [4] Vattenfall. [5] Ørsted. [6] EU 2025/1176. [8] Rendaq. [10] Energy Voice.

01 WHAT A MONTH OF WAITING COSTS

Price the pause, so the board can see it

No public dataset measures the time lost between procurement gates. What can be priced is the value of a month, on your own numbers.

ANALYSIS

Example project: 60 MW solar, 11% capacity factor ASSUMPTION	**57,816 MWh a year**
Revenue at the AR7 solar clearing price: 57,816 × £65.23[7]	**about £3.77m a year**
20 years of that revenue today, at 7% ASSUMPTION : £3.77m × 10.594[9]	**about £39.9m**
Revenue starts one month later: £39.9m × (1 − $1/1.07^{1/12}$)	**about £0.22m lost**
Revenue starts two months later	**about £0.45m lost**
The 18-month milestone is missed	**the contract itself is at risk**[1]

Revenue only, before costs, indexation and merchant tail. The capacity factor and discount rate are assumptions to replace. Method at the end.

Six places a package waits

1 Design not frozen
Packages are redrawn after the strategy is signed.

2 Scope rewritten
Market sounding notes are retyped into tender documents.

3 Questions asked twice
Every bidder asks the same question, answered by email.

4 Offers in different shapes
Each offer is restated by hand before it can be ranked.

5 Model and contract drift
Terms move in negotiation; the model catches up later.

6 Lender pack built last
Due diligence starts from a blank folder.

IGNIS VIEW A pattern list from commercial practice, not survey data. Your pause audit (page 9) shows which apply to you.

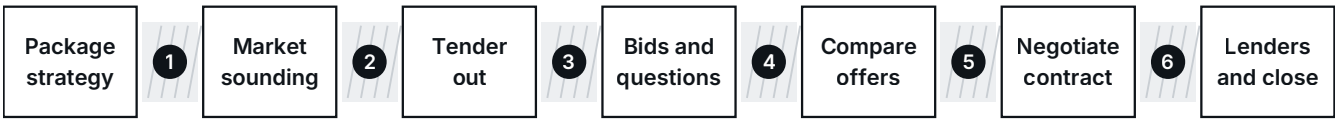
Sources on this page: [1] DESNZ, AR8 CfD Agreement. [7] DESNZ, 10 Feb 2026 (AR7 solar £65.23/MWh, 2024 prices). [9] DESNZ, AR7 government response (20-year CfDs).

02 SEVEN GATES, RUN IN PARALLEL

The gates stay. The waiting between them goes.

The same seven gates, run two ways. In the redesigned flow the next gate's pack is prepared while this gate is decided.

TODAY: EACH GATE WAITS FOR THE LAST ONE TO FINISH



1. Design not frozen, so packages are redrawn
2. Scope rewritten for the tender documents
3. The same questions asked by every bidder
4. Offers arrive in different shapes and scopes
5. The model and the draft contract drift apart
6. Due diligence starts from a blank folder

Pauses and gaps: work stops, or is redone, while the next gate gets ready.

REDESIGNED: THE NEXT GATE IS PREPARED BEFORE THIS ONE CLOSES



Agent groundwork prepares the next pack in parallel; named people decide at each gate

One project record underneath every gate

Scope, packages, offers, clarifications, model inputs, contract terms and lender answers, versioned and owned

IGNIS VIEW A framework, not data.

What stays the same

The gates, the decisions and the people who take them. Shortlist, preferred bidder, risk allocation and signature stay with your team and your board.

What changes

The next pack is drafted while this gate is decided. Nothing is retyped. A change is approved once and reaches every document that uses it.

02 STARTING BEFORE THE ROUTE IS SECURED

Procurement starts before the round is won

Early supplier work is money at risk, but the bid and the 18-month milestone both need it. Do it once, on one record, and it becomes your first tender pack.

1 Sound the market

A long list per package, with capacity, lead times and delivery slots for the target year.

2 Indicative prices into the floor price

Current supplier prices and dates feed capex and the bid, not last year's numbers.

3 Evidence the round can score

Delivery and resilience evidence gathered once, for the round and later for lenders.

4 A draft package strategy

Packages, interfaces and contracting approach sketched, so gate 1 opens with a draft.

The pre-award spend decision

Package type	Typical stance before award	Why
Long-lead equipment, such as large transformers	Sound the market, secure slots or reservation terms where affordable	Lead times of up to 4 years[3]
Main construction packages	Tender-ready pack, shortlist agreed, contract draft from last agreed terms	Award to preferred bidder soon after the result
Short-lead and standard packages	Long list kept current only	Little to gain from early spend

IGNIS VIEW A starting position to test against your risk appetite, not a rule. The board sets the limit per project.

Agent groundwork

- Supplier long lists and market notes kept current, with dates.
- Every supplier question logged, so none is asked twice before and after award.
- Indicative prices and dates linked to the bid model.

The team decides

- How much to spend before award, project by project.
- Which suppliers to engage, and on what terms.
- The capex and dates the bid rests on.

Sources on this page: [3] IEA, Building the Future Transmission Grid.

03 THE PAUSE AUDIT

Pause audit worksheet

Package _____ Project _____ By _____

How to use it. Take one package closed in the last two years. Enter the date each gate closed and the next one opened. For each gap, write what the team was waiting for, mark the cause code and say whether the wait was chosen on purpose.

Between gates	Closed	Next opened	Days	What were we waiting for?	Code	Chosen?
1 Strategy to 2 Sounding						
2 Sounding to 3 Tender						
3 Tender to 4 Bids						
4 Bids to 5 Compare						
5 Compare to 6 Negotiate						
6 Negotiate to 7 Close						
Total						

Cause codes

D	Design or scope not frozen	**M**	Contract and model inconsistent
Q	Duplicated or unanswered questions	**L**	Lender evidence missing
R	Offers restated by hand	**V**	Version conflict and rework
A	Waiting for an approval or a decider	**X**	External: grid, consent, supplier, round

Read the result

Circle the two longest gaps that were not chosen. Name an owner for each fix. Leave the rest for now.

Some pauses pay

A design freeze that prevents a change order is worth waiting for. Mark it "chosen" and record the reason.

Free to copy and use with your team. A spreadsheet version follows the same columns.

03 MEASURES TO ESTABLISH

Seven measures to set up before you promise any saving

These are measures to establish, not results. Ignis publishes no benchmark for them. Your pause audit sets the baseline; the next package shows whether the redesign works.

1 Waiting time between gates	Days from one gate closing to the next opening, per package. Source: gate dates in the record.
2 Duplicated questions	Clarifications that repeat an earlier question, from any bidder. Source: the clarification log.
3 Offer restatements	Times an offer is re-keyed or restated by hand before ranking. Source: comparison grid history.
4 Clarifications without owner or due date	Open items with no named owner or no date, counted weekly. Source: the clarification log.
5 Contract and model inconsistencies	Differences in price, dates or risk terms found by the consistency check before each gate.
6 Missing lender evidence	Lender questions that could not be answered from the record on the day asked.
7 Rework from version conflict	Documents redone because two versions of scope, price or dates were in use.

How to run them

- Count from the record, not from memory.
- Report them at every gate, beside the decision.
- Keep the definitions fixed for a year.

What they are not

They are not targets or performance claims. Set targets only after two packages have been measured on the same definitions.

IGNIS VIEW Definitions proposed by Ignis. Adjust them to your process, then keep them stable.



PART TWO | FIX THE EVIDENCE

Make every gate ready before the last one closes

What must be true to enter and leave each gate, how supplier returns arrive, and how contract, model and lender pack stay in step.

4	Evidence and control at each gate	12
5	Supplier-return structure and comparison	15
6	Clarifications and exception handling	17
7	Contract, financial model and lender pack	18

Photo: Dennis Schroeder, NREL, U.S. Department of Energy. Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons.

04 EVIDENCE AND CONTROL AT EACH GATE

Seven gate-control cards

Each card says what must be true to enter and leave the gate, who owns it, what agents prepare and what a person decides. Roles are examples; use your own delegation of authority.

GATE 1 Package strategy

Entry: Anchor route and target delivery year set; design basis issued

Exit: Signed package strategy with interfaces and owners

Required evidence: Design basis, grid offer and date, consent conditions, capex estimate

Owner: Head of procurement

Agent groundwork: Draft package options from the record; list interfaces; map lead times against the grid date

Human decision: Package split, contracting approach, pre-award spend limit

Exceptions and escalation: A lead time beyond the grid date goes to the commercial director

Reusable output: Package strategy and interface register

GATE 2 Market sounding

Entry: Package strategy signed

Exit: Shortlist per package; dated indicative prices in the model

Required evidence: Long list with capacity, slots, indicative price, lead time and resilience evidence

Owner: Head of procurement, with the technical lead

Agent groundwork: Keep long lists current; log supplier questions; link indicative prices to the bid model

Human decision: Which suppliers to engage, and which prices go into the bid

Exceptions and escalation: Too few credible suppliers sends the package back to gate 1

Reusable output: Supplier long list with evidence dates

How to use the cards

Copy one card per gate into your procurement procedure. Fill each field for your own process and roles. A gate is not passed until its exit criteria and its human decision are on the record. Agents prepare the groundwork; they never pass a gate.

04 EVIDENCE AND CONTROL AT EACH GATE

GATE 3 Tender out

Entry: Shortlist approved; design frozen for this package

Exit: Tender issued; return template and criteria locked

Required evidence: Scope, interfaces, programme with grid date, draft contract, return template

Owner: Package lead

Agent groundwork: Assemble the pack from the record; check scope against interfaces; draft from last agreed terms

Human decision: Pack approval; evaluation criteria and weights, set before bids arrive

Exceptions and escalation: A design change after issue becomes one addendum to all bidders

Reusable output: Tender pack and return template

GATE 4 Bids and questions

Entry: Tender issued; clarification log open

Exit: All bids in; every question closed or carried as a qualification

Required evidence: Bids in the return template; the clarification log

Owner: Package lead

Agent groundwork: Log questions; spot duplicates; draft answers from the record; route each to an owner with a date

Human decision: Any answer that changes scope, price basis or risk; deadline extensions

Exceptions and escalation: A question without an owner by the agreed time goes to the head of procurement

Reusable output: Clarification log and answer library

GATE 5 Compare offers

Entry: Bids complete; open clarifications listed

Exit: Preferred bidder with a written reason; restated price in the model

Required evidence: Like-for-like grid on one scope and one index; programme against grid date

Owner: Head of procurement, with the finance lead

Agent groundwork: Restate each offer onto the grid; flag gaps, exclusions and dates; price gaps on stated assumptions

Human decision: Which gaps matter and what they are worth; shortlist and preferred bidder

Exceptions and escalation: A material gap goes back to the bidder through the log, not by email

Reusable output: Comparison grid and offer history

04 EVIDENCE AND CONTROL AT EACH GATE

GATE 6 Negotiate contract

Entry: Preferred bidder approved

Exit: Contract agreed; consistency check clean

Required evidence: Mark-up against last agreed positions; risk register; model on contract terms

Owner: Commercial lead

Agent groundwork: First mark-up; issues list; consistency check of contract, model and comparison after each turn

Human decision: Risk allocation, caps, security, concessions and the walk-away

Exceptions and escalation: Any change to price, dates or risk needs a named approval first

Reusable output: Terms won and conceded; negotiation log

GATE 7 Lenders and close

Entry: Contract agreed or near final; model frozen for due diligence

Exit: Conditions precedent met; documents signed

Required evidence: Contract, model, technical evidence, supplier credit and security, programme

Owner: Finance and funding lead

Agent groundwork: Answer lender questions from the record with citations; track the due diligence list; flag conflicts

Human decision: Answers that create commitments; financing terms; signature

Exceptions and escalation: A finding that needs a contract change returns to gate 6 under change control

Reusable output: Lender question library; data room index

Five checks before any gate closes

1. Contract, model and comparison agree on scope, price, dates and risk.
2. Every clarification is closed or carried as a named qualification.
3. Every change since the last gate carries a named approval.
4. The date register still meets the grid date and the CfD milestone.
5. The record is updated and the seven measures are reported beside the decision.

IGNIS VIEW Cards and checks are Ignis frameworks, free to use with your team.

05 SUPPLIER-RETURN STRUCTURE

Ask for offers in the shape you will compare them

Most restating happens because each bidder chooses its own format. Fix the format in the tender, and comparison starts on the day bids arrive.

#	Return section	What the bidder provides	Feeds
1	Scope compliance	Line-by-line compliance against your scope and interface list	Comparison grid
2	Exclusions and assumptions	Every exclusion and assumption, in one list	Clarification log
3	Price schedule	Prices on your cost breakdown, base date and index	Model and capex
4	Programme	Dates against your key dates, including the grid date	Date register
5	Contract deviations	Each deviation from the draft contract, clause by clause	Mark-up and risk register
6	Security and credit	Guarantees, bonds and financial statements	Lender pack
7	Delivery and resilience	Capacity, slots, supply chain and resilience evidence	Round and lender pack

IGNIS VIEW A structure to adapt to each package, not a standard form.

Three rules

- A return outside the template is logged as a clarification, not reworked by your team.
- One base date and one index for every price.
- Every deviation tied to a clause number.

Onshore and offshore

Offshore runs fewer, larger packages with long supplier lists for each. Onshore runs more, smaller packages, often across several projects. The same return structure serves both.

05 COMPARING OFFERS LIKE FOR LIKE

Ranking offers on different scopes is ranking scopes

Restate every offer onto one grid first. The real differences then show in days, not in the final week.

HOW A LIKE-FOR-LIKE GRID READS

Line	Supplier A	Supplier B	Supplier C	What the agent raises
Scope and interfaces	Same	Gap	Same	B leaves out one interface
Exclusions	Same	Same	Ask	C has not stated them
Programme against grid date	Same	Gap	Same	B misses the connection date
Price and indexation	Same	Ask	Same	Restated onto one index
Delay damages and caps	Same	Same	Gap	Below your last agreed position
Security and credit	Same	Excluded	Same	No parent guarantee
Delivery and resilience	Same	Ask	Same	Evidence the bid and lenders need

Same: matches the tender. **Gap:** differs and changes the price. **Ask:** unclear, goes to the log. **Excluded:** not offered.

IGNIS VIEW A framework, not a real tender.

Agent groundwork

- Read every return and map it onto the grid.
- Flag gaps, exclusions and dates that miss the grid date.
- Restate prices onto one scope and one index, with the assumptions shown.

The team decides

- Which gaps matter, and what they are worth.
- The shortlist and the preferred bidder.
- Where to push and where to concede.

06 CLARIFICATIONS AND EXCEPTION HANDLING

Every question has one owner, one date and one answer

A clarification asked by email has no owner. Put each one in a log, answer it once and send the answer to every bidder.

Clarification log

Package _____

No.	Question	From	Owner	Due	Changes scope, price, dates or risk?	Sent to all

Exception rules

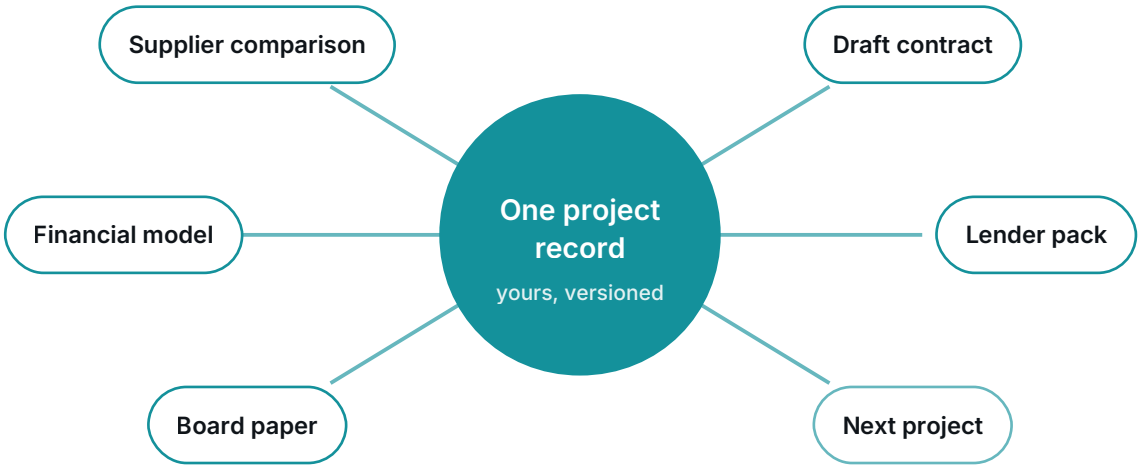
Exception	Who decides	What is recorded
An answer changes scope, price basis or risk	Package lead, with the commercial lead	Addendum to all bidders, dated
A question has no owner by the agreed time	Head of procurement	Owner and new date
A bidder asks for more time	Head of procurement	Same extension for all, with reason
A return arrives outside the template	Package lead	Clarification to the bidder
A design change after tender issue	Technical lead	Change note, re-pricing request

IGNIS VIEW Roles are examples. Agents log, de-duplicate and draft; a named person approves every answer that leaves the business.

07 CONTRACT, FINANCIAL MODEL AND LENDER-PACK ALIGNMENT

When contract, model and lender pack read one record, nothing drifts

A change in negotiation reaches the contract, the model and the lender pack at once, with a name and a date.



What has to agree before each gate closes

Item	Comparison	Contract	Model and lender pack
Scope	The restated scope	Scope of works	Capex and contingency
Price	Restated price	Contract price and indexation	Capex and cost case
Dates	Programme against grid	Key dates and delay damages	Schedule and milestone tests
Risk	Gaps and exclusions	Caps, warranties, security	Risk register and downside case

Approve changes, do not email them. A price, date or risk moves only with a named approval on the record. The consistency check runs before every gate.

Lenders ask familiar questions. Keep every question and answer from the last close, and the next data room starts from them.



PART THREE | KEEP CONTROL

People decide. The record remembers.

Who holds authority at each gate, which risks are never delegated, and what the next package inherits.

8	Human authority and risk allocation	20
9	The reusable project record	21
	Worked example: one package through the gates	22
10	Self-check and next step	24

Photo: Kristelle Batucal, U.S. Department of Energy. Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons.

08 HUMAN AUTHORITY AND RISK ALLOCATION

Agents prepare and check. Named people commit.

Each role keeps the judgement and the relationships. The groundwork beneath it is bounded, logged and testable.

Role	Agent groundwork	The person keeps
Head of procurement	Tender packs, the clarification log, the comparison grid	Package strategy, shortlist, supplier relationships
Commercial lead	First mark-up from your last agreed terms; issues list	Risk allocation and the negotiation
Finance and funding lead	Model updates, consistency checks, lender answers	The financing case and lender relationships
Technical lead	Interface and programme checks against the grid date	Design choices and technical sign-off
CEO and board	A board paper from the record, with open risks	The investment decision and the signature

Never delegated to an agent

- Delay damages, caps and liability
- Security and credit support accepted
- Interface risk between packages
- Indexation and price adjustment
- The walk-away and the signature

How agents are bounded

- Read the record; never change it without an approval
- Cite the source of every figure they use
- Send nothing outside the business
- Stop at every gate for a named decision
- Sample-checked by the gate owner each gate

IGNIS VIEW Roles are examples. Supplier prices stay in your environment, and every read, change and approval leaves an audit trail.

09 THE REUSABLE PROJECT RECORD

One record per project, built gate by gate, reused on the next

The record is yours: in your environment, under your access rules. Each package leaves it more useful for the next.

Record item	Created at	Reused at
Package strategy and interface register	Gate 1	Every tender pack; the next project's gate 1
Supplier long list with evidence dates	Gate 2	The next sounding; the round's delivery evidence
Tender pack and return template	Gate 3	The next tender for a similar package
Clarification log and answer library	Gate 4	Answers to repeat questions; lender questions
Comparison grid and offer history	Gate 5	Price benchmarks for the next bid and capex
Terms won and conceded	Gate 6	The starting mark-up on the next contract
Lender question library and data room index	Gate 7	The next due diligence
Date register: grid, CfD milestone, supplier programmes	All gates	Every gate and board paper

Three rules for the record

- Every item has an owner and a date.
- One version in use; old versions kept, not deleted.
- Changes to price, dates or risk carry a named approval.

The test

A new package lead could open the record and start the next tender without asking where anything is.

THE WIDER OPERATING MODEL

This playbook applies the Ignis model to one workflow. Why process comes first and data second, how agents, connectors and human gates fit together, build or buy, adoption and the 90-day path are covered once, in the flagship guide **Agentic Transformation for Energy Developers**: ignisleadership.com/resources/agentic-transformation-for-energy-developers

WE WORKED EXAMPLE: ONE PACKAGE THROUGH THE GATES

COMPOSITE EXAMPLE, NOT A CLIENT

Package T1: the substation and main transformer for a 60 MW solar project

Fictional, built from situations common to UK developers. Project facts are assumptions; market facts are sourced.

Commercial pressure why now	The project bids in AR8, with sealed bids indicatively due 3 to 9 December 2026.[8] If it wins, the 18-month spend milestone starts at signature in March 2027.[1,8] Large transformers can take up to 4 years.[3] Grid date in 2029. ASSUMPTION
Decision the commitment	How far to take T1 before the AR8 result: sound the market only, or issue the tender and agree a preferred bidder subject to award.
Evidence what it depends on	Grid offer and connection date; design basis; supplier slots and indicative prices; the draft contract from the last agreed terms; the floor price in the bid model.
Current workflow what goes wrong today	The tender waits for the result. Offers arrive in each bidder's format and are restated by hand. Clarifications sit in email. The model is updated after negotiation. The lender pack is built at the end. ASSUMPTION
Agent groundwork bounded tasks	Keep the long list and slot evidence current. Assemble the tender pack and return template from the record. Log and de-duplicate questions. Restate offers onto the grid. Check contract, model and comparison after each turn. Draft lender answers with citations.
Human authority who commits	The board sets the pre-award spend limit. The head of procurement approves the shortlist and criteria. The commercial lead allocates delay and interface risk. The finance lead signs off the model. The CEO signs.
Control checks sources, permissions, trail	Every figure cites the record. Nothing goes to a bidder without the package lead's approval. Price, date and risk changes carry a named approval. The consistency check is clean before gates 5, 6 and 7.
Reusable output what feeds the next package	The return template, the answer library, the comparison grid, terms won and conceded, and the lender question library.

Sources for the worked example: [1] DESNZ, AR8 CfD Agreement. [3] IEA. [8] Rendaq.

WE WORKED EXAMPLE: ONE PACKAGE THROUGH THE GATES

T1 through the redesigned workflow

Gate	What happens	Pause it targets
1 Package strategy	Signed before bids close, with the transformer split out as long-lead	Design not frozen
2 Market sounding	Slots and indicative prices dated and linked to the bid model	Scope rewritten
3 Tender out	Issued before the result, with the return template and criteria locked	Waiting for award
4 Bids and questions	One log; each answer sent to all bidders	Questions asked twice
5 Compare offers	Returns mapped to the grid on arrival; preferred bidder subject to award	Offers in different shapes
6 Negotiate contract	Mark-up from last agreed terms; check after each turn	Model and contract drift
7 Lenders and close	Pack built from the record as each gate closes	Lender pack built last

BOARD DECISION AND RATIONALE

Decision: take T1 to a preferred bidder before the AR8 result, within a pre-award spend limit set by the board. Contract signature only after award. ASSUMPTION

Why: the transformer lead time is the longest on the project and the milestone clock starts at signature. The spend at risk is limited to tendering and any reservation terms the board accepts.

Measures the team sets up

- Days between each gate
- Duplicated questions and offer restatements
- Contract and model inconsistencies found
- Lender questions not answered from the record

What this example does not claim

It is not a client case and reports no results or time saved. The measures are set up to find out.

T1 against the AR8 calendar ASSUMPTION internal dates

When	Step
Before 9 December 2026	Gates 1 and 2 closed; indicative prices dated in the bid model
December to January	Gate 3: tender out; gate 4: bids and one clarification log
15 to 17 February 2027	AR8 results (indicative)[8]; gate 5 preferred bidder confirmed if awarded
4 to 17 March 2027	CfD signed (indicative)[8]; gate 6 negotiation already under way
About September 2028	18-month milestone falls due[1] ANALYSIS

10 SELF-CHECK AND NEXT STEP

How fast can your next package move?

Tick what is true today, not what is planned.

- ☐ We know where our pauses between gates are, and roughly how long each lasts
- ☐ Package strategy starts before the round result, within a set spend limit
- ☐ Each gate has entry and exit criteria and one named owner
- ☐ Bidders return offers in our template, on our cost breakdown and index
- ☐ Every offer is restated onto one scope before it is ranked
- ☐ Clarifications sit in one log, each with an owner and a due date
- ☐ The grid date, CfD milestone and supplier programmes sit in one date register
- ☐ The financial model reads the same terms as the draft contract
- ☐ The lender pack is built as we go, not at the end
- ☐ Terms won and conceded on the last contract are where the next one starts

Score. 0 to 3: run the pause audit on one package and set up a date register. 4 to 7: add the return template, the log and the consistency check, then the agent groundwork. 8 to 10: you are ready to run more packages with the same team.

NEXT STEP

A commercial diagnosis on one live package

We take one package you are about to tender. Together we run the pause audit, test the gate controls and the evidence behind them, and leave you with a first set of gate-control cards and the two fixes that matter most. Your team decides. Start at **ignisleadership.com/contact**

+ SOURCES AND METHOD

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9. DESNZ, "Further reforms to the CfD scheme for AR7: government response", Jul 2025. https://www.gov.uk/government/consultations/further-reforms-to-the-contracts-for-difference-scheme-for-allocation-round-7
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Method. 60 MW × 8,760 hours × 11% = 57,816 MWh a year. Present value uses a 20-year annuity at 7% (10.594), matching the 20-year CfD term.[9] A delay of m months discounts the stream by $1.07^{m/12}$. Revenue uses the AR7 solar clearing price as a proxy and ignores costs, indexation and merchant tail. The capacity factor, discount rate and composite project facts are assumptions. Gate cards, grids, logs and measures are Ignis frameworks, not data. All sources checked on 2 November 2026.

Disclaimer. A commercial view only, not legal, regulatory or investment advice. Rules, dates and contract terms change; check the current documents before you act.



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